consider the period starting from the 1991 Gulf War as a revolution in military affairs, especially in the US forces. The 1999 Kosovo campaign, and the 2001 US campaign in Afghanistan against the Talibans witnessed sea changes in war tactics. Integration of diverse forces, using information-rich battle management systems, forced the adversaries to succumb. The 2003 Iraq war was another incident where the chief aim was to 'shock and awe' the enemy. To this end, the US used cruise missiles to disarm the enemy. In 1993, President Bill Clinton attacked the Iraqi intelligence with dozens of cruise missiles which became the first all-cruise-missile attack in history.[38] Therefore, these newer generations of military technologies have changed the military power calculation and have a definite impact on the adversaries, which conventional forces might not have. States often want to be perceived as militarily strong and are willing to use their capabilities and thus do not want to be challenged or thwarted. Demonstration of prowess might be explicit through display of military capabilities or implicit, as may be the case with the possession of nuclear weapons. India's nuclear explosion of Pokhran I and Pokhran II was an attempt to attain the status and prestige among her neighbours which is, to a great extent, thwarted by the presence of her northern neighbour China.

Possession of nukes has shaped the nuclear strategy adopted by the nuclear powered states. Either it may be "first strike" as Pakistan has adopted or "second-strike" as India has adopted. There can also be a situation as was the case during the Cold War between USA and the Soviet Union, which came to be known as **mutually assured destruction** or **MAD** because both possessed second-strike capabilities. But the important point is that mere possession of nukes would deter an adversary from using its missile. During the Cold War days it was acknowledged by both the Soviet and American leaders that there are few, if any, goals that can be served by the actual 'use' of nuclear weapons and the 'threat' to use nuclear weapons plays a more decisive role. It is said, "A nuclear war cannot be won and never be fought". Therefore, deterrence can be considered as one of the means by which one state can prevent certain actions of political adversaries. Effective deterrence should be 'stable' as well as 'credible'. It should be both 'threatening' in the